



Deadpool 2 trailer coming

Celebrating its two year release, the Deadpool 2 trailer will be dropping with Black Panther. <http://digit.in/DDPoolBP>



Detective Pikachu begins filming

The live-action movie of Detective Pikachu begins filming with Ryan Reynolds voicing Pikachu. <http://digit.in/DetPika>

The planets most likely to harbour life

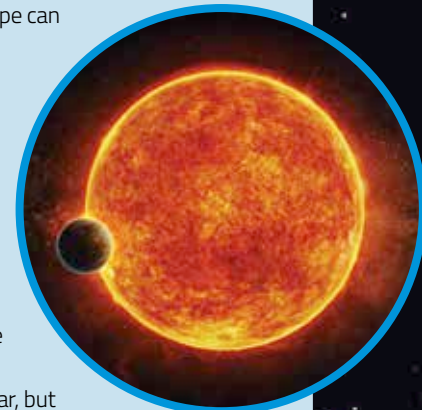
These are the known planets most likely to harbour extraterrestrial life.

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The Habitable Exoplanets Catalog maintained by the Planetary Habitability Laboratory at the University of Puerto Rico in Arecibo has been listing potential homes of aliens for six years. There are two lists of potentially habitable exoplanets, a conservative list and an optimistic list. The conservative list has more stringent requirements, and thus more chances of harbouring life. The planets here are from the conservative list. The naming convention is the name of the star followed by an alphabet, which denotes the number of the planet, with the list starting from b. For example, Earth would be named Sun d. Proxima b has been excluded as recent evidence suggests that the exoplanet is too old and bombarded with too much radiation to support life. The planets here are all rocky, just the right distance from their host stars for liquid water to exist on the surface, and consequently most likely to have the conditions necessary to support life as we know it on Earth.

LHS 1140 B

The planet passes in front of the star every 25 days as seen from the Earth, which makes it a great candidate for future observations by more powerful telescopes. Astronomical instruments such as the James Webb Space Telescope can in the future, scan the light that passes through the atmosphere of the planet, for signs of life. The planet is a super Earth, about 40 percent larger than the Earth, and about 6.6 times denser. The planet could have once been inhospitable because of the harsh ultraviolet radiation from an energetic young star, but now the host star has cooled down. LHS 1140 is 40 light years away in the constellation of Cetus.



LHS 1140 b.

Image: Harvard-Smithsonian Center for Astrophysics.

GLIESE 677 CC

From the surface of GJ 677 C c, also known as Gliese 667 C c, an observer can behold three stars in the sky at once. The stars are all smaller than the sun. Gliese 667 C c is in orbit around the smallest star, a red dwarf. The planet may be tidally locked to the star. In this case, one side is forever in cold darkness, while the other side enjoys an hot endless day. The twilight zone between the two sides, known as the terminator line, is where life is most likely to exist. The host star is about 23 light years away and appears in the constellation of Scorpius.



GJ 677 C c or Gliese 677 C c.

Image: ESO/L. Calçada

TRAPPIST-1 F

The TRAPPIST-1 system is incredibly interesting, considering that there are seven rocky planets in orbit around the ultracool red dwarf star. Three of the planets, e, f and g are all in the habitable zone. All seven planets are closer to the host star than Mercury is to the sun. The planets are tidally locked. Between the two sides is a zone of perpetual twilight, where anyone on the surface can enjoy a sunset frozen forever in time. An observer on the surface can see all the other planets in the sky, and discern surface details as well. The star is about 40 light years away and appears in the constellation of Aquarius.



Artist's concept of TRAPPIST 1 f.

Image: NASA/Spitzer.